Beyond the Claw Building Your Personal Coding Agent

Erik Hanchett



Meet Erik Hanchett

ErikCH

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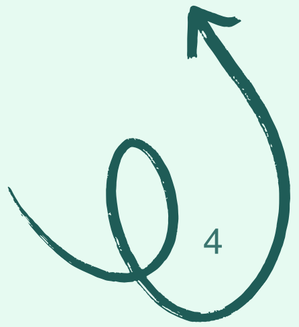
Erik Hanchett is a Senior Developer Advocate at AWS, where he focuses on Kiro. He has taught software development for more than 10 years on his YouTube channel, Program With Erik, which has over 100,000 subscribers.





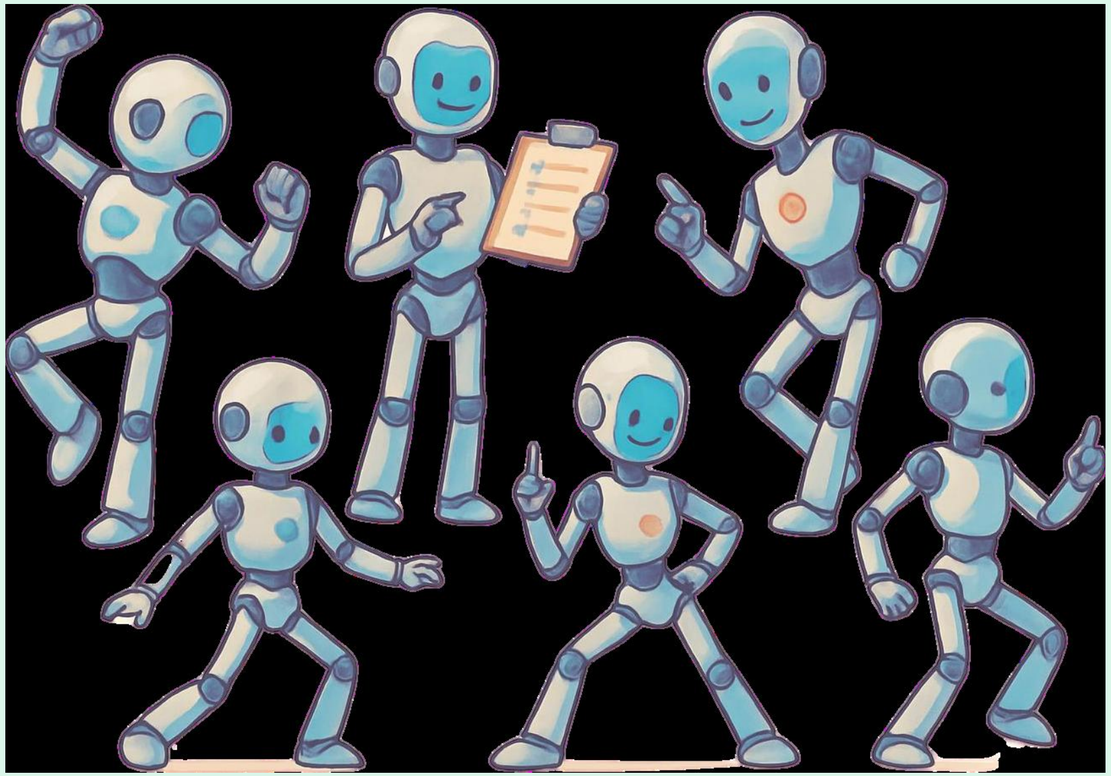
My agent reads the tech news before I wake up

What's a Claw?

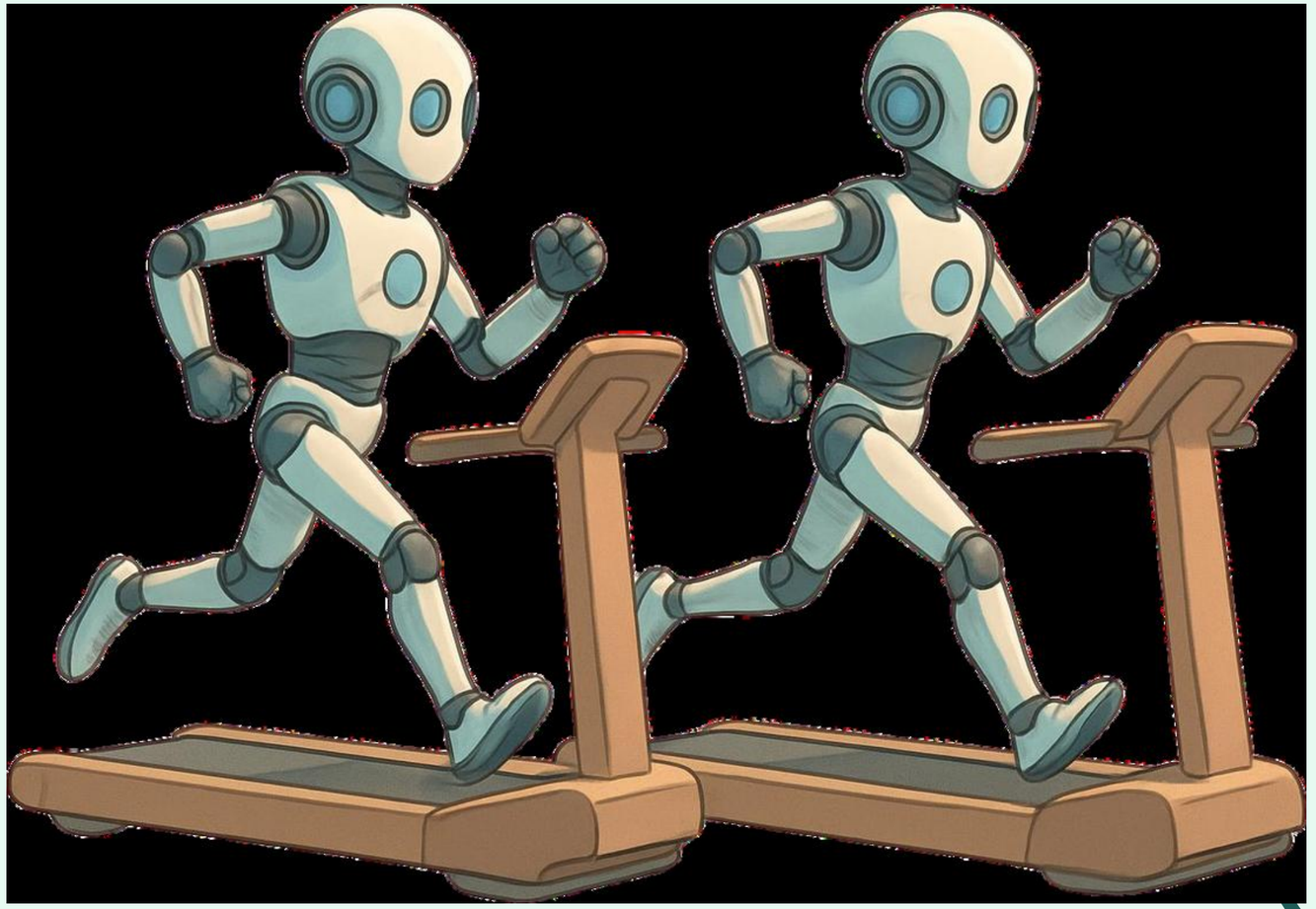


What makes a Claw

- Always on, your machine
- Uses shell, browser, MCP
- Remembers across sessions
- Runs on a schedule
- Chat from Slack or Telegram
- Learns skills over time



Coding agent vs. Claw



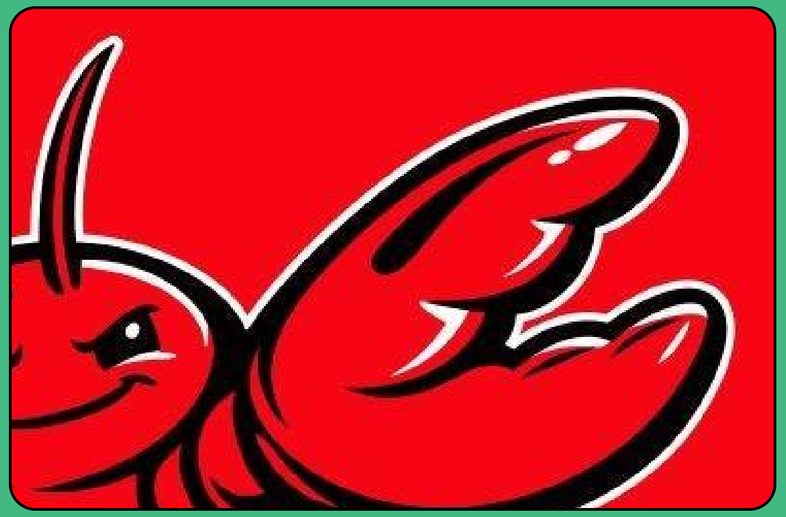
Coding agent

You start a session, it does the task, it stops. Nothing runs until you come back.

Claw

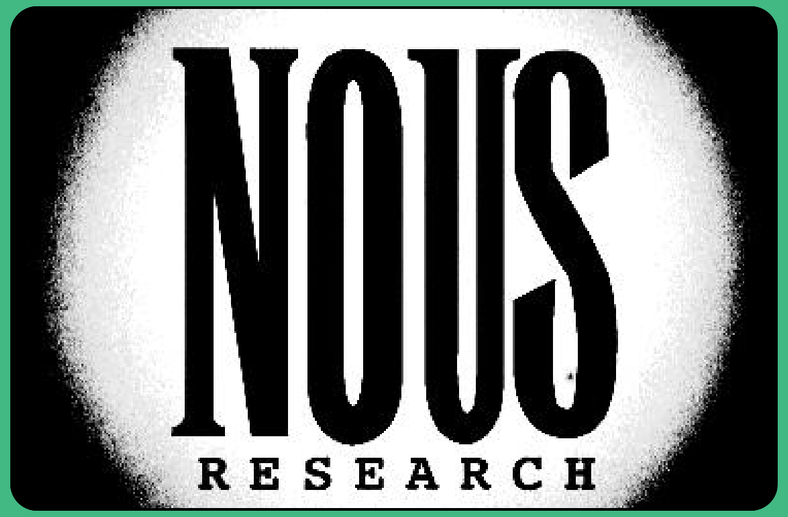
Always running. It wakes on a schedule, remembers context, and pings you when needed.

The Claw landscape in 2026



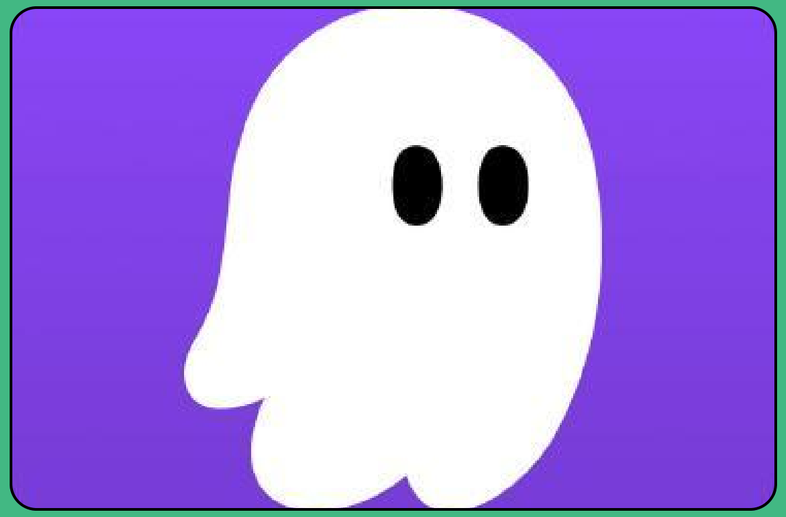
OpenClaw

393K GitHub stars. Self-hosted, chat-app first, huge skill hub.



Hermes Agent

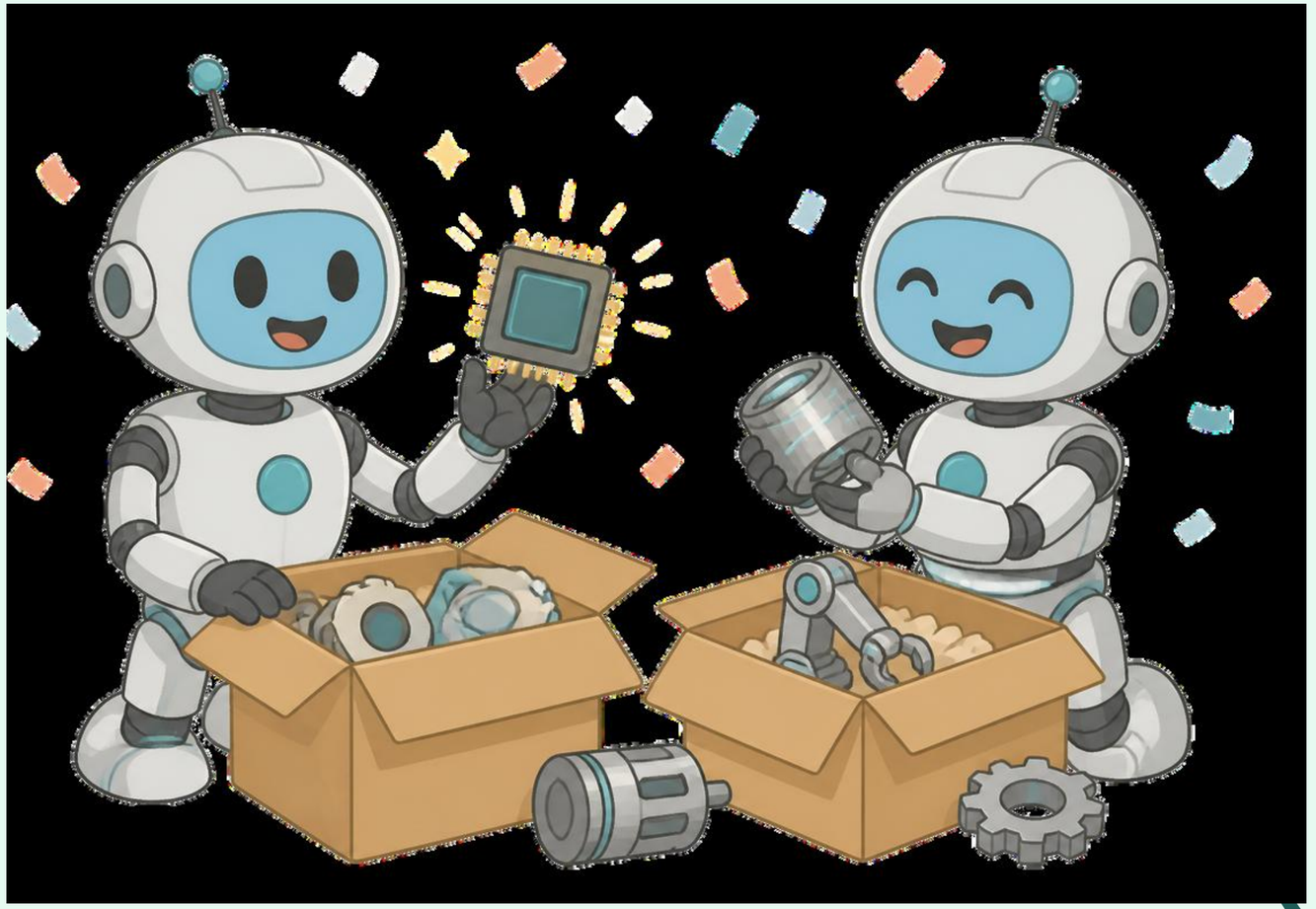
Nous Research. Learning loop that writes its own skills.



Kiro Crew

AWS, open source. A dev workspace with sandboxing built in.

What changed this year



OpenClaw 2.0 (Aug 30)

Rebuilt browser UI with chat in the center, SQLite sessions, shared cloud sessions.

Hermes Agent v0.20

Bot Mode: named bots, each with its own memory, skills, and model.

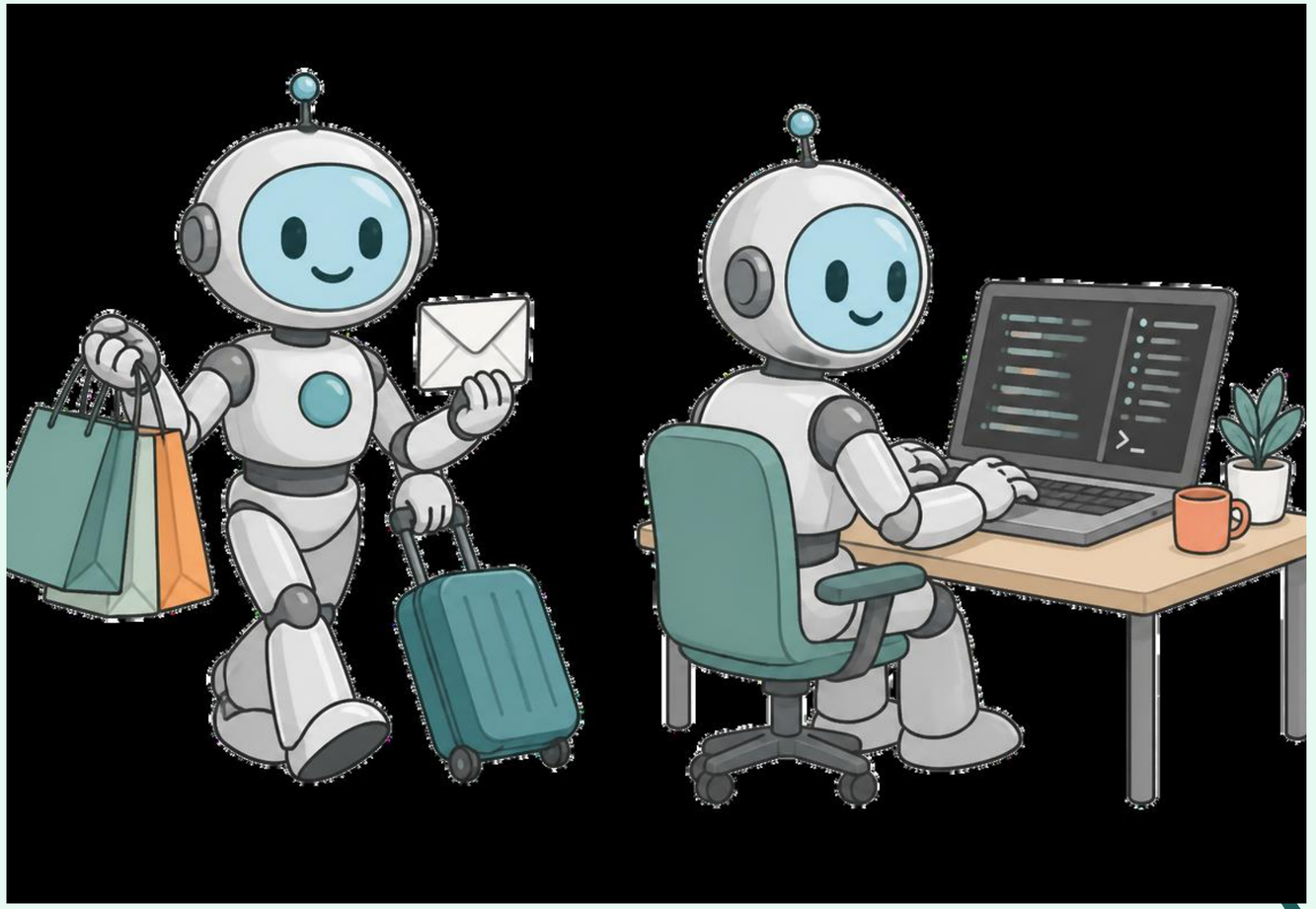


It used to be scary

42,000+ exposed instances

Early 2026: CVE-2026-25253 (CVSS 8.8) let one malicious link take over a running OpenClaw. Researchers also found 824 malicious skills on ClawHub, out of about 10,700.

Two kinds of agents



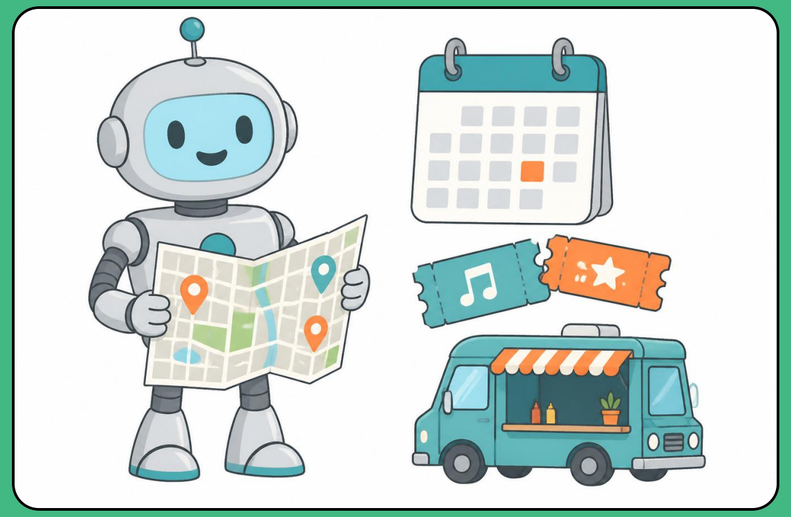
Consumer agents

OpenAI Dots and Meta Muse run in their cloud and handle email, travel, and bills.

Developer Claws

OpenClaw, Hermes, and Kiro Crew run next to your repos, tools, and terminal.

Beyond code



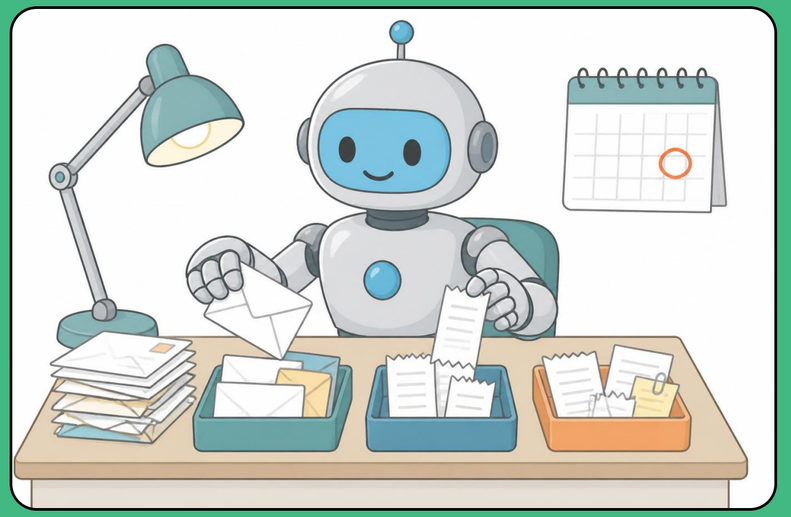
Local events

A Friday cron finds events near you this weekend and pings Telegram.



Travel day

A heartbeat checks your flight and texts you when the gate changes.



Bills and renewals

A monthly cron checks your inbox for due dates and reminds you early.

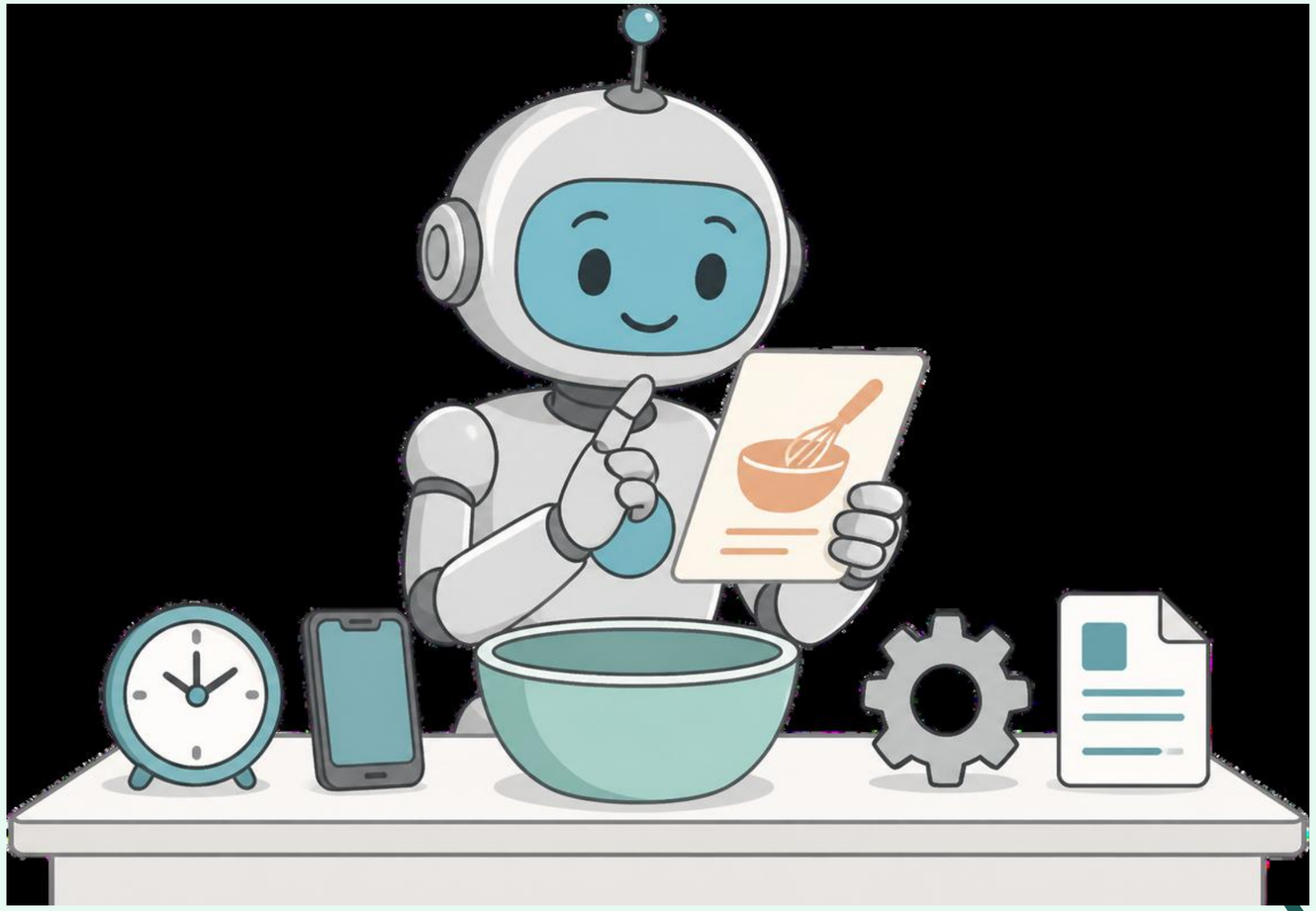
Recipe: travel day

HEARTBEAT.md

- [ ] Check flight UA 1234. If the gate or departure time changes, text me.

The text message

aws sns publish
--phone-number "$MY_PHONE"
--message "Gate moved to B12"



Meet Kiro Crew



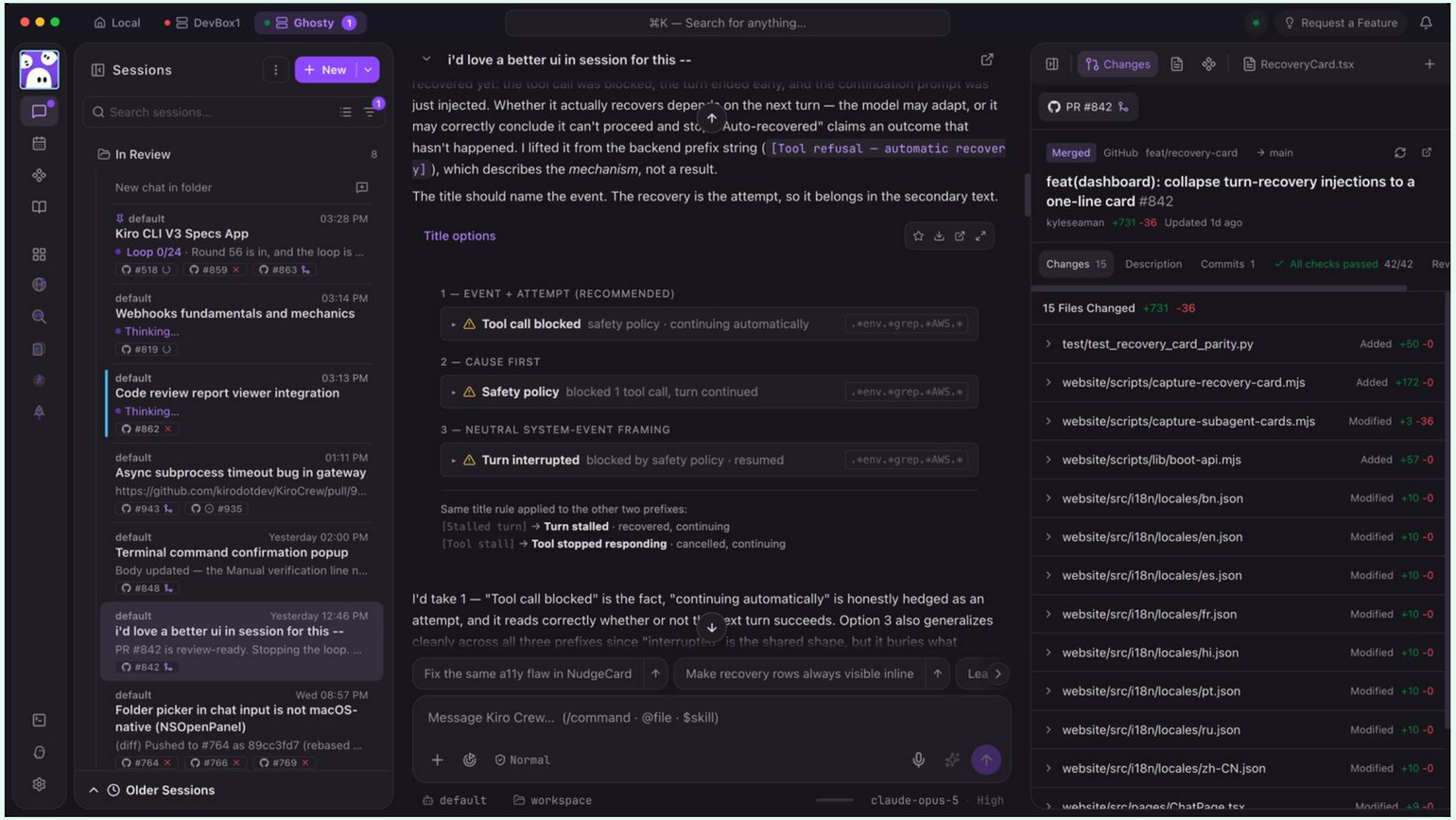
Kiro Crew

Open source. Runs on your hardware.

Launched August 2026, 4,600+ GitHub stars. Use it from the desktop app, web dashboard, CLI, Slack, Discord, or Telegram. Kiro CLI by default, with Claude Code, Codex, and others in preview.

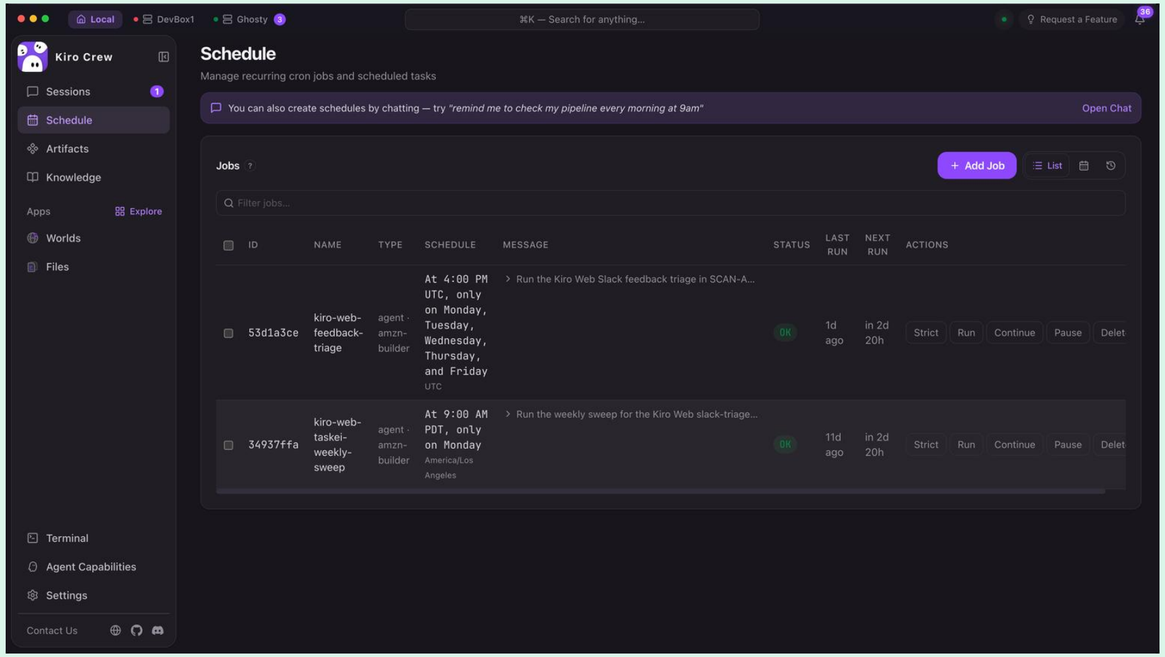
Chat first

- Files and approvals sit around the chat



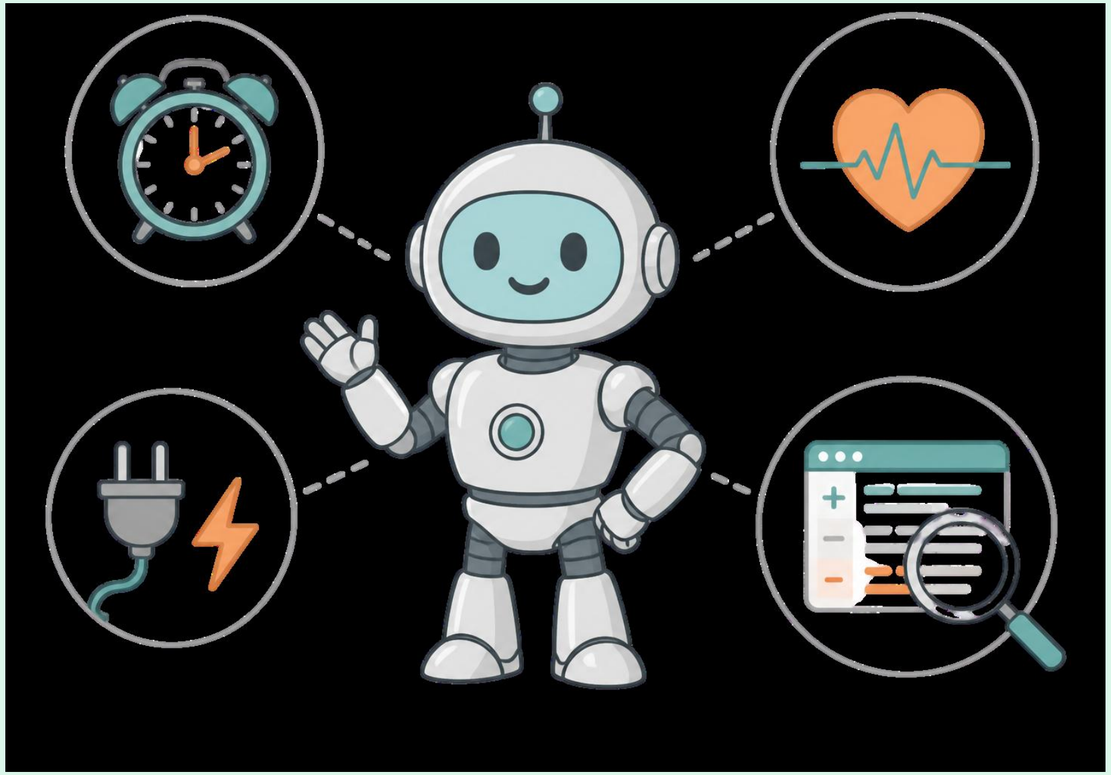
My morning tech news run

A scheduled job asks Crew to research technology news and send me a digest. It reuses one session, so it remembers what it already covered. Results land in the dashboard or Slack.

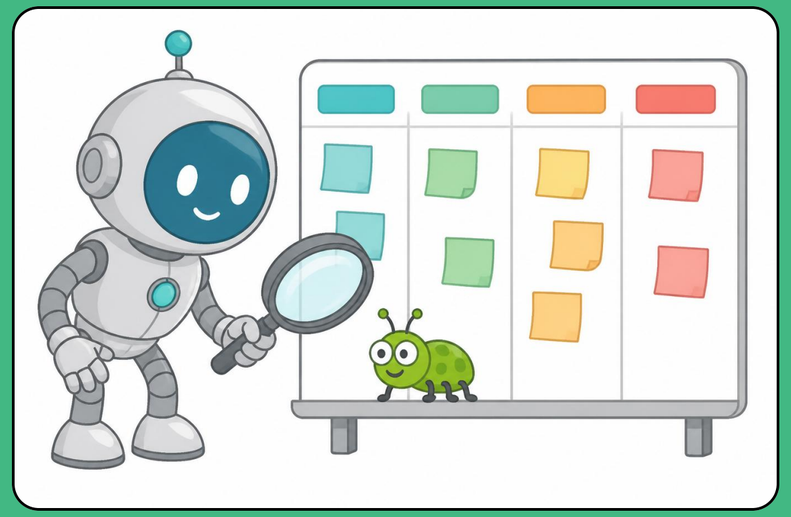


Other ways to use it...

- Cron: every weekday at 7
- Heartbeat: tell me when X
- Webhook: CI calls Crew
- PR watch: wakes on change
- Script cron: no model calls
- Task runner: overnight specs

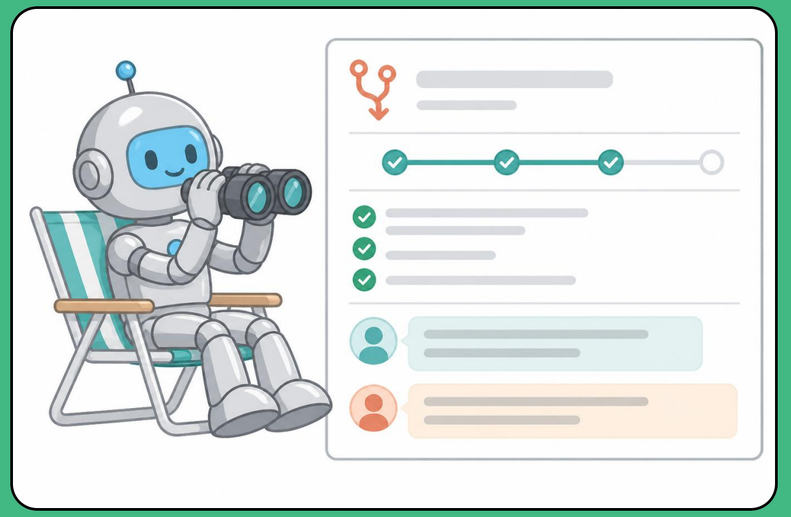


Chores for your code



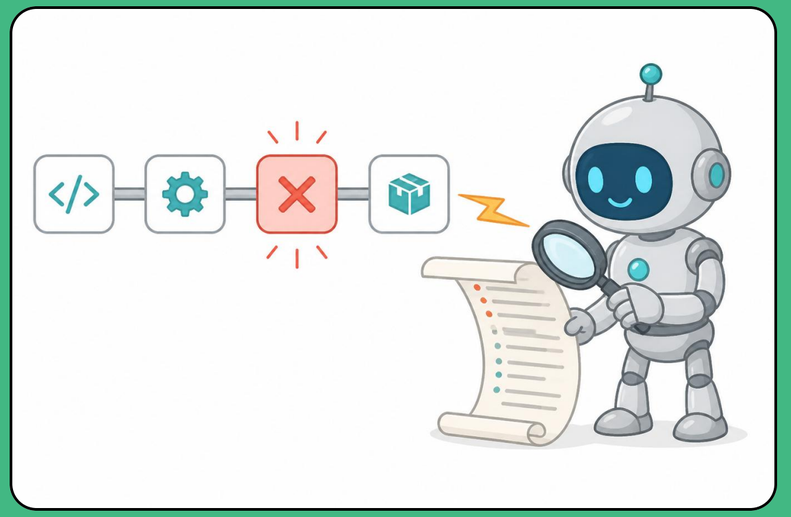
Morning bug triage

Cron reads new issues, tries a repro, and posts a summary to Discord.



PR babysitter

A watch that wakes only when CI or review comments change.

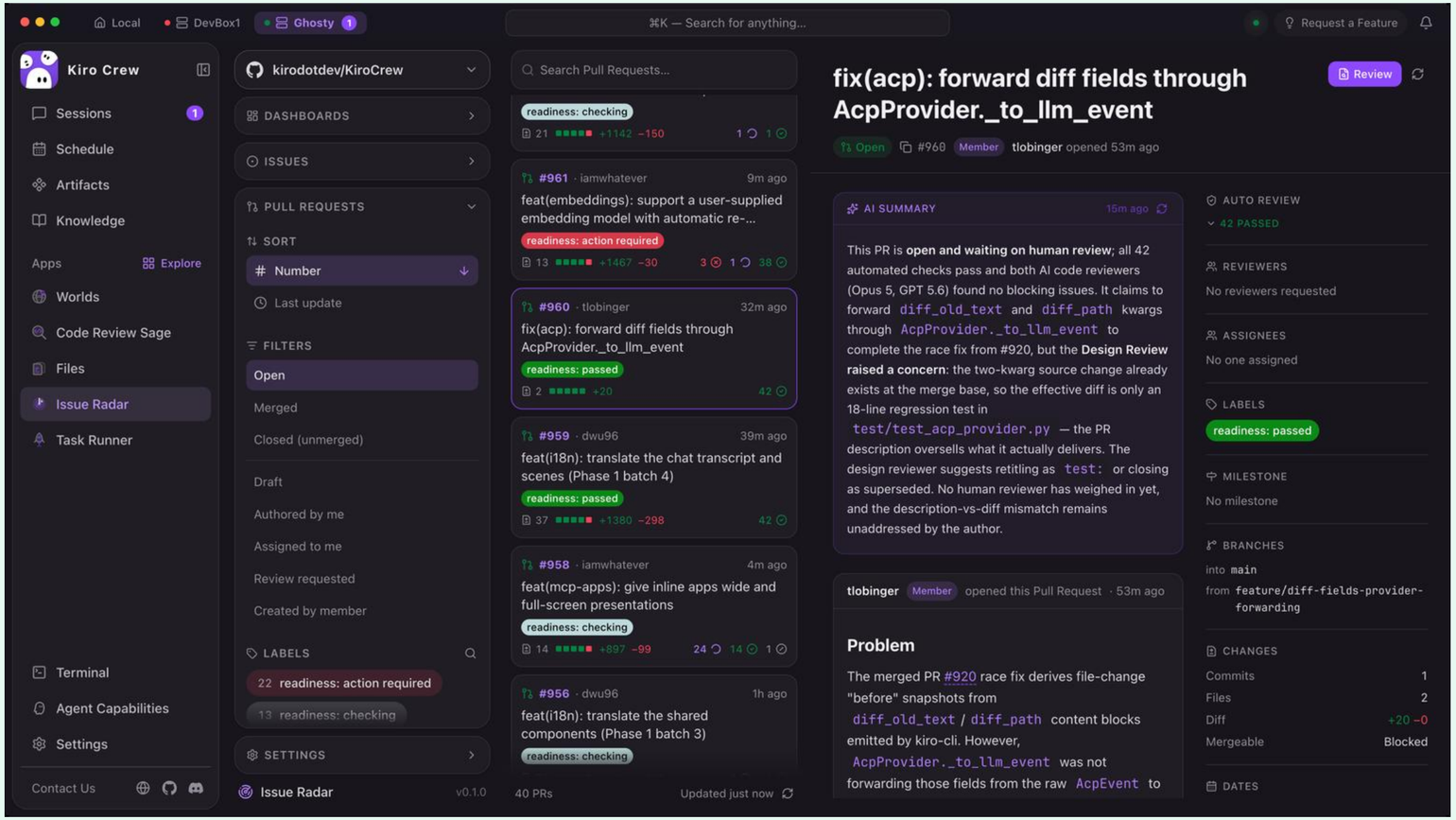


CI failure webhook

Your pipeline calls Crew. It reads the logs and reports the cause.

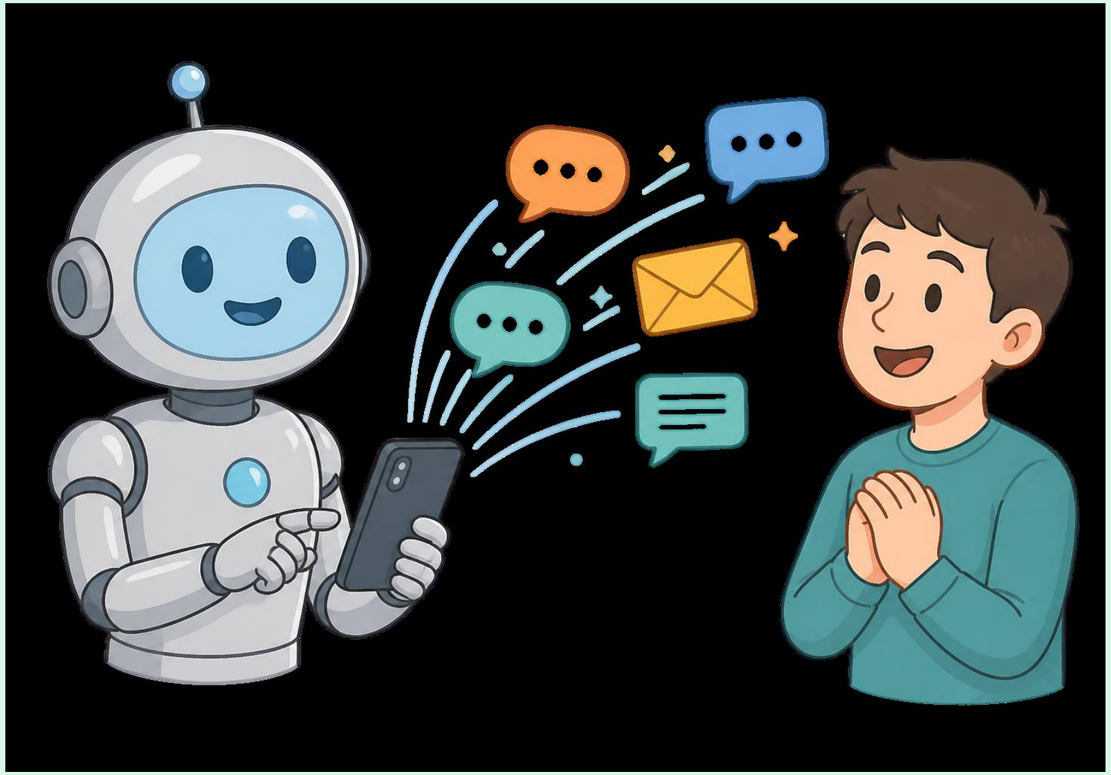
Built-in apps

- Issue Radar: PR readiness and AI summaries



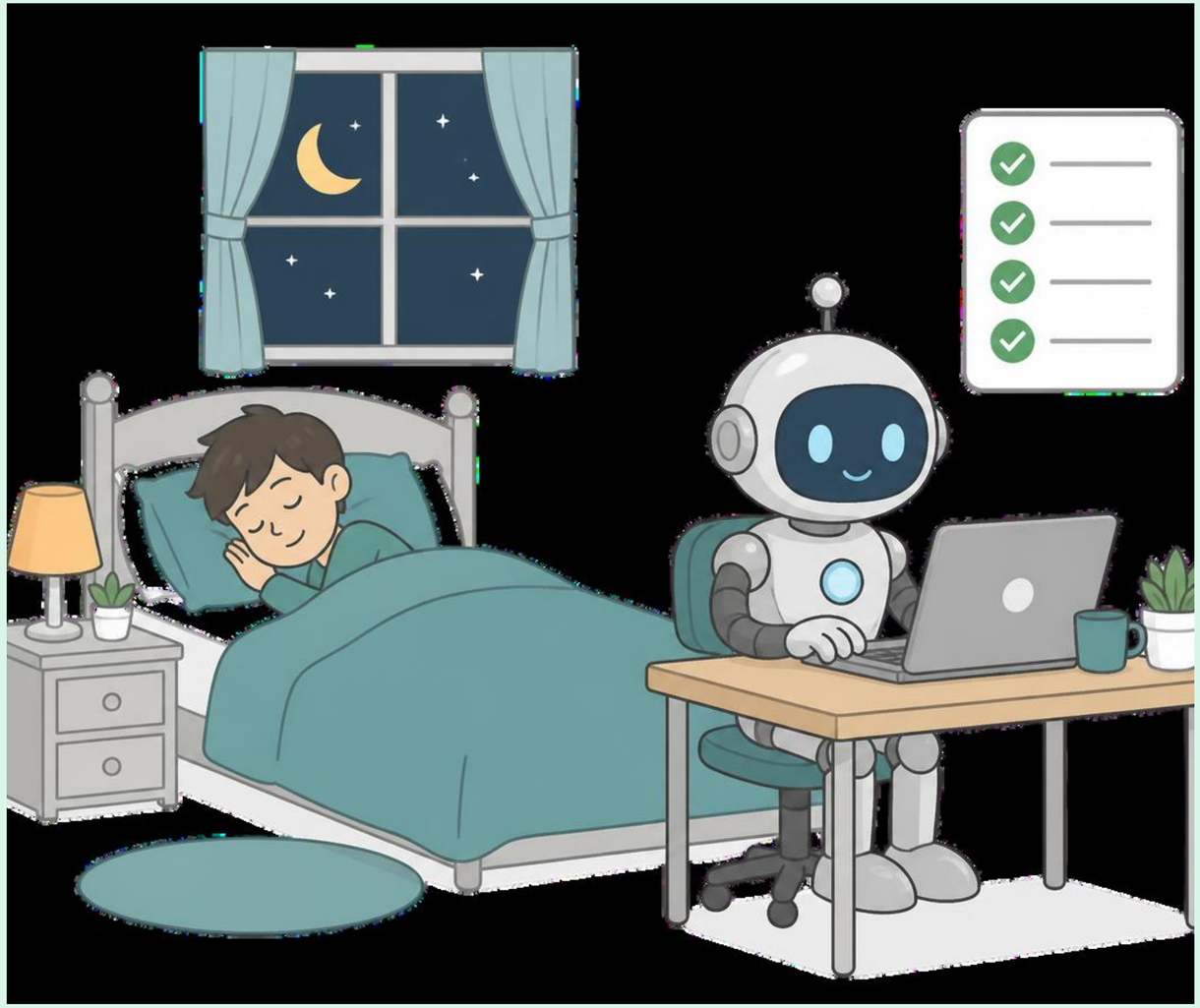
Reach it anywhere

- Slack, Discord, Telegram
- WhatsApp and iMessage
- Teams, Webex, WeChat
- Text or email via Amazon SNS
- Approve tools from your phone
- Same memory everywhere



While you sleep

- Trust this command
- Trust this tool
- Autopilot per session
- Deny rules always apply
- Cron gets no extra trust

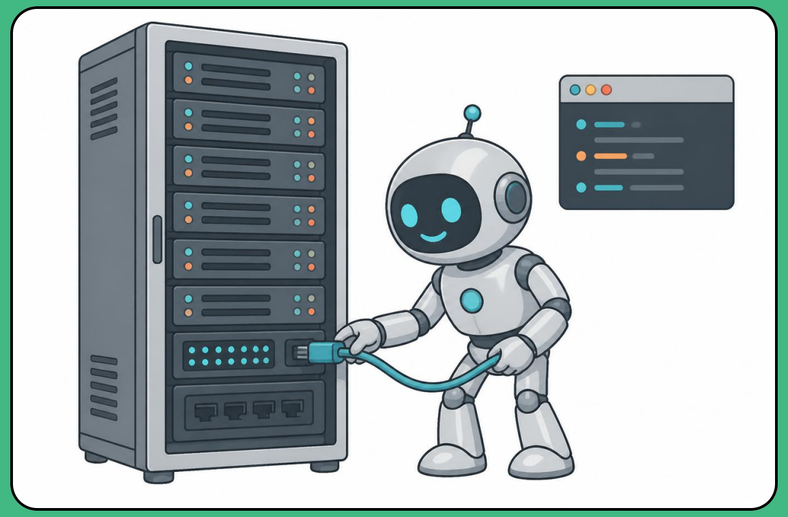


Where it runs



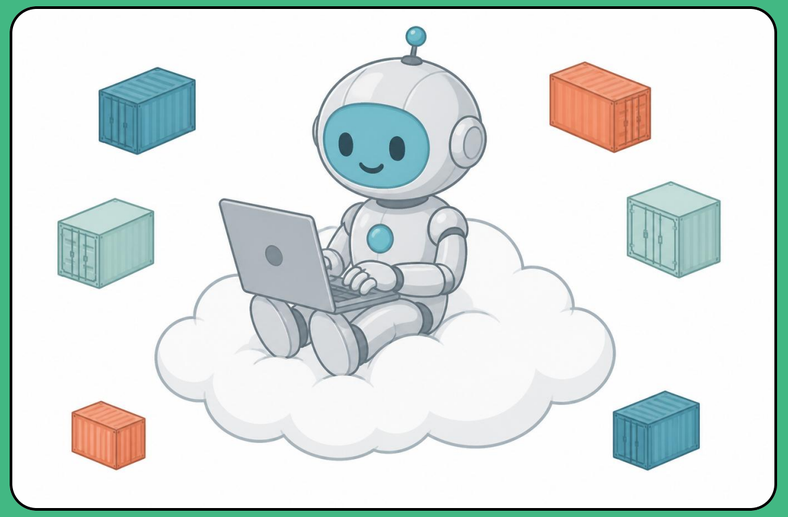
Mac mini

Desktop app, or kirocrew service install so it restarts on boot.



Your own VPS

Any Linux box with 16 GB RAM. Reach the dashboard over SSH.

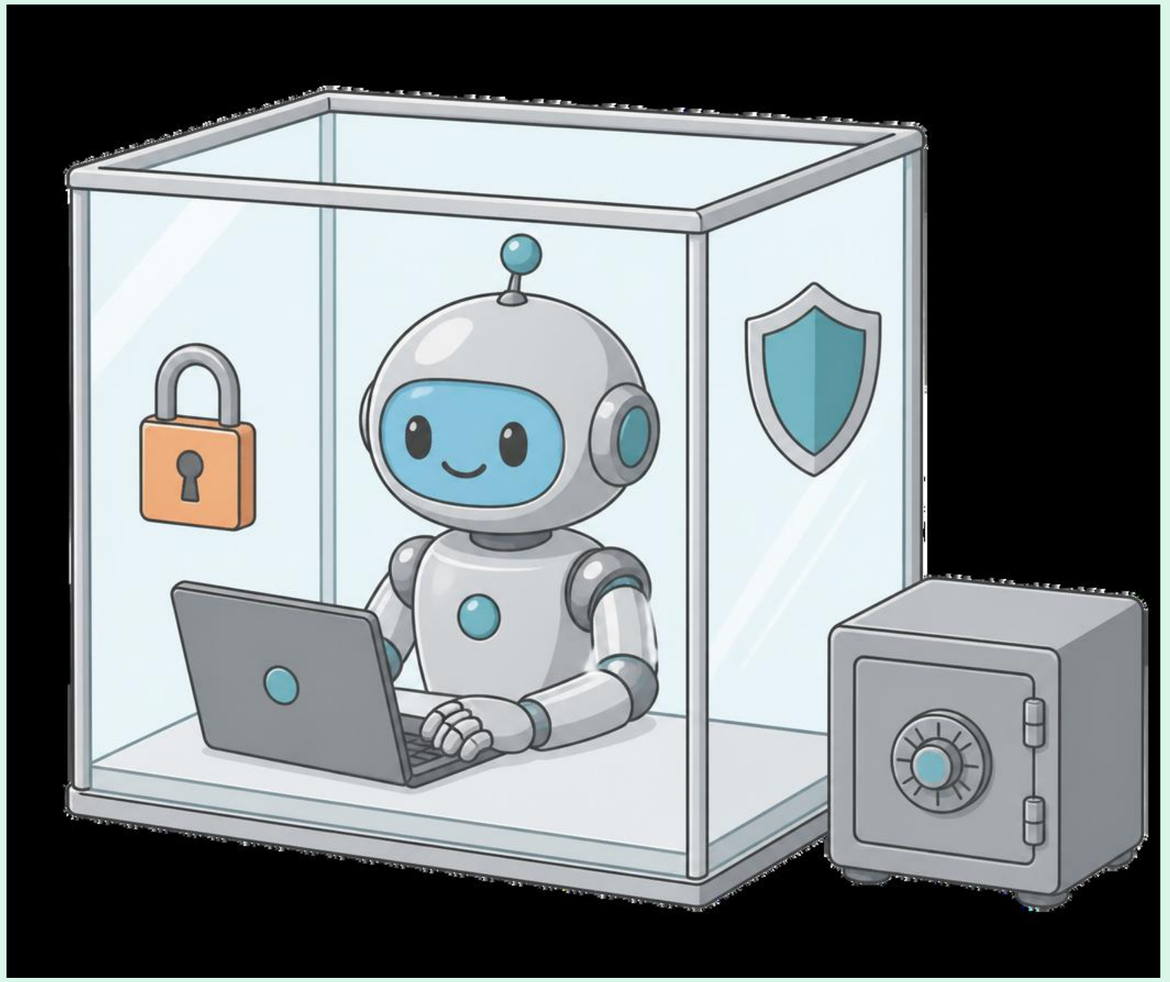


The cloud

Docker image, or a Fargate remote crew with no inbound ports.

Secure by default

- OS sandbox, fails closed
- Denied commands
- Credential redaction + vault
- Owner lock on every channel
- Localhost + token auth
- Audit log you can verify



Governance

- **Tightest policy wins**
- **Agent can't raise its limits**
- **One policy for the fleet**



Still rough edges

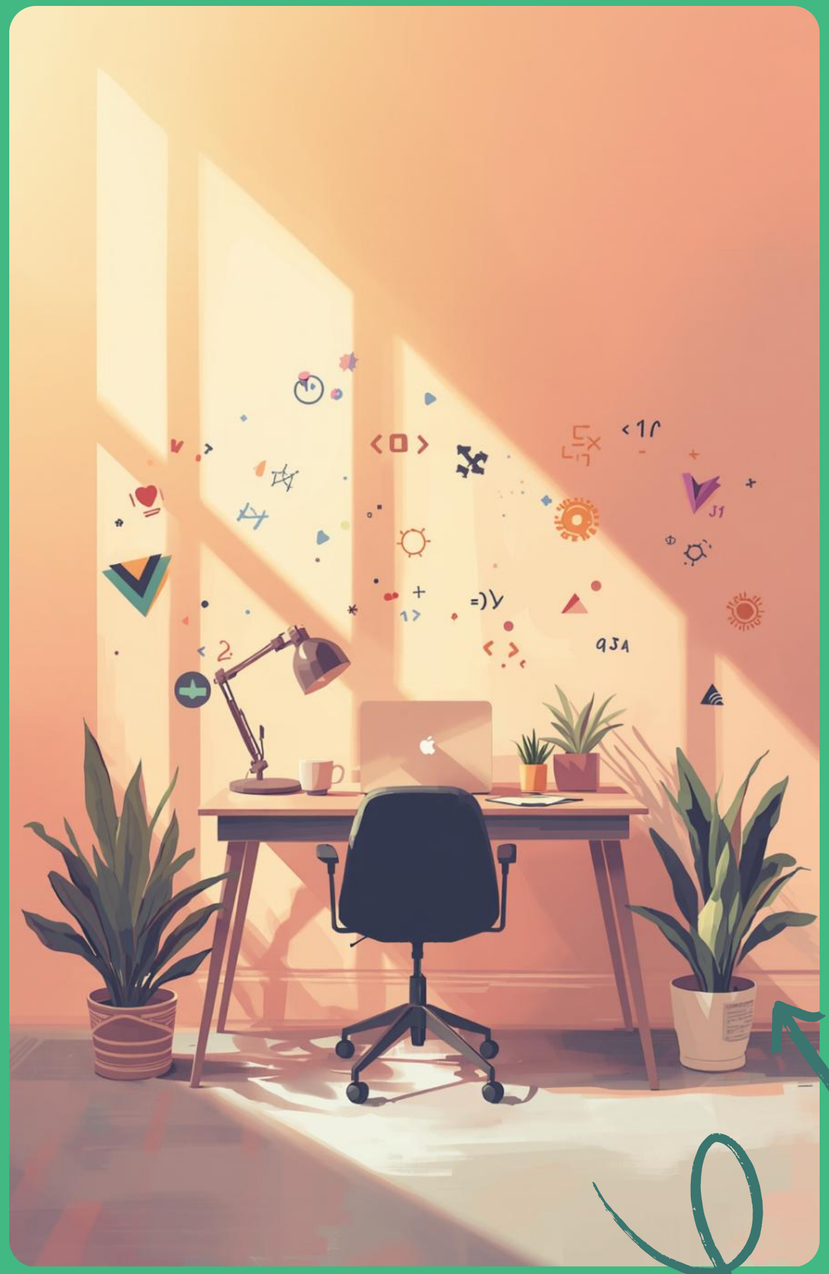
- Long tasks still fail
- Prompt injection isn't solved
- Scheduled jobs burn credits
- You still review the work



Start this week

- Install the desktop app
- Pick one boring chore
- Schedule it
- Sandbox on, Autopilot off





Thank You!

Connect with me on LinkedIn

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